LV_NEO
Tech for Luxury experiences

HACKATHON LV_NEO / FILE N° INFRA-042 / CONFIDENTIAL

OPERATION LAST HARVEST

07:42. Lavier XESCHAEVE's phone rings. A forgotten site is alive — and exposed.



01 / THE CALL

The 07:42 phone call

THE CALL
Inès, night-shift SOC analyst, dials Lavier XESCHAEVE, our CISO. She doesn't say hello.
"Someone is probing the old *Dernière Récolte* server. It's still online. And it's still ours."

THE SCENE
A Louis Vuitton pop-up called "Dernière Récolte", retro greengrocer décor. Closed for years — its admin site never was.

THE SUSPECT
One monolithic PHP site, one PostgreSQL database, one Linux box. Run by an outside contractor.

THE CATCH
Olivier, an external contractor, built the website and holds the code and the keys. His contract with us ends tonight.

YOUR MISSION
The site looks non-critical — but scanning attempts and surrounding activity have been observed. Retrieve our code, redeploy it on infrastructure we control, and close off access afterwards.

EXPECTED SUCCESS
By 15:00 the site runs on our cloud: reproducible, secure, demonstrable. Then we decide what to do with it.

02 / THE EVIDENCE BOARD

Exhibits on Lavier's desk

Four exhibits, one story. Read them together — or miss the plot.

A / THE SITE
"Food Inventory Database": one PHP page, one server, zero scalability.

B / THE DATABASE
Labelled "anecdotal" by Olivier — yet a nightly job still reads it, and the final stocktake isn't closed.

C / INÈS'S LOGS
Unknown IPs hitting an unpatched endpoint since 06:58. Nobody noticed.

D / OLIVIER'S EMAIL
"I can patch it today. After that, I'm off contract and off your servers."

FOLLOW THE DATA
It must never be offline for more than a few minutes.

03 / THE CLOCK

One day. Five moves. No second chance.

SPRINT #1 / GET IN
10:15 → 11:30
Start building. Coaches and experts on call. Split roles, find the critical path.

LUNCH / KEEP THE PACE
12:30 → 13:00
Buffet open, clock running. Who eats, who watches the database? Expect a call.

SPRINT #2 / BUILD & PROVE
13:00 → 15:00
Prototype, test, iterate. The new infra must live without Olivier.

SHOWTIME / FACE THE JURY
15:00 → 16:00
Team presentations and live demos. Lavier is in the room.

DEBRIEF / CLOSE THE FILE
10 min
A 300-word debrief. Bonus for the most original format.

04 / THE NEW HOME

Where the code must land before Olivier walks out

SOURCE
PHP / configuration / SQL initialization

CONTAINER
Versioned and reproducible image

PLATFORM
Secure and scalable PaaS or CaaS

DATA
Managed PostgreSQL + backup

EXPORT
Weekly pull to S3

CI/CD
Validation, deployment and proof

ENGINEER'S RULE
If it isn't versioned, automated or documented, it doesn't exist.

05 / WHAT OLIVIER LEFT BEHIND

Clues the best detectives won't miss

THE HANDOVER SHARE
index.php, config.php, db_connect.php and an init SQL script. Nothing else.

OLIVIER'S "HINTS" FILE
Half-finished notes on environment variables and DB init. Trust, but verify.

WHAT IS REALLY WANTED
Weekly S3 export, CI/CD pipeline, clear documentation, design faithful to the real business.

CONTINUITY
Prove that the data remains accessible during the switchover.

SAFETY
Secrets, network exposure, patches and least privilege.

OPERABILITY
Logs, monitoring, backups and recovery procedures.

06 / THE HANDOVER

What you hand in at 15:00

SHOWTIME: rebuild, deploy, test — and tell the story.

L1 / INFRASTRUCTURE AS CODE
Terraform: versioned, readable, rerunnable.

L2 / SECURE PLATFORM
PaaS or CaaS with controlled scalability.

L3 / AUTOMATED EXPORT
Weekly export to an S3 bucket.

L4 / SUPPLY CHAIN
CI/CD pipeline, documentation and demo.

AT 15:00 THE JURY ASKS THREE QUESTIONS
Does the platform work? Can we rebuild it without Olivier — or you? Is it safer and easier to operate?